004-04 The Mechanics’ Strike of 1920 / 1920年的机械工人罢工

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1. The Mechanics’ Strike of 1920 /1920年的机械工人罢工

The mechanics’ strike 罢工 of spring 1920 was the first strike in Hong Kong organized by a labor union 工会, the Chinese Mechanics 机械学，力学 Institute 研究所，学院，协会；.

The union demanded *a 40 percent increase* in wages 工资.

Although the Hong Kong dollar **had depreciated (v.)贬值；跌价 by 50 percent** /since the outbreak of World War I /and prices **had risen significantly** 显著地；明显地, Chinese workers’ wages were **no higher 不高于 than** before the war.

(European workers, who already enjoyed higher wages than Chinese workers, **had received** increases (n.) of around 15 percent.)

Rice **had been sent to Europe** in 1919 **to relieve 缓解；减轻；解除 food shortages** there, **leading to** such *severe (a.)十分严重的；严厉的 shortages* and *price increases* in Hong Kong that the government **had to** impose 强制实行；推行 price limits.

To support their demands, *the Chinese Mechanics Institute* enlisted (v.)谋求（某人的帮助）；征募，参军 the services of Lo Man Kam, a prominent Eurasian 欧亚混血的；欧亚的 lawyer.

After employers —mainly the dockyards 造船厂；船坞区, electric companies 电力公司, and the government itself —**turned down** 拒绝 four requests, the workers **went on strike** 罢工 on March 31.

Within a week, almost ten thousand workers were *on strike*, bringing Hong Kong’s economy to a standstill (n.)停滞；停顿.

Many of the strikers went to Canton, where they **were supported** by Sun Yat-sen’s government and local labor unions.

Although most people in Hong Kong, including many Europeans, considered the workers’ demands (n.) justified 合理的；正当的；有正当理由的, the employers refused to

yield (v.)屈服；让步.

The strike lasted (v.) for more than three weeks, and only after pressure (n.)压力，挤压 from *Secretary 秘书；部长，大臣；（英国大使、大臣的）助理 for Chinese Affairs* E.R.Hallifax did the employers eventually concede 让步；承认；给予 to a 32.5 percent *pay increase* 加薪 for the workers.

Example 1. 案例

The mechanics' strike of spring 1920 was the first strike in Hong Kong organized by a labor union, the Chinese Mechanics Institute.
The union demanded a 40 percent increase in wages.
Although the Hong Kong dollar had depreciated by 50 percent since the outbreak of World War I and prices had risen significantly, Chinese workers' wages were no higher than before the war.
(European workers, who already enjoyed higher wages than Chinese workers, had received increases of around 15 percent.) Rice had been sent to Europe in 1919 to relieve food shortages there, leading to such severe shortages and price increases in Hong Kong that the government had to impose price limits.
To support their demands, the Chinese Mechanics Institute enlisted the services of Lo Man Kam, a prominent Eurasian lawyer.
After employers—mainly the dockyards, electric companies, and the government itself—turned down four requests, the workers went on strike on March 31.
Within a week, almost ten thousand workers were on strike, bringing Hong Kong's economy to a standstill.
Many of the strikers went to Canton, where they were supported by Sun Yat-sen's government and local labor unions.
Although most people in Hong Kong, including many Europeans, considered the workers' demands justified, the employers refused to yield.
The strike lasted for more than three weeks, and only after pressure from Secretary for Chinese Affairs E. R. Hallifax did the employers eventually concede to a 32.5 percent pay increase for the workers.

1920年春季的技工罢工是香港历史上首次由工会——中国技工学会——组织的罢工。该工会要求加薪40%。尽管自第一次世界大战爆发以来港元贬值了50%，物价也大幅上涨，但中国工人的工资却与战前持平。（欧洲工人的工资本来就高于中国工人，战后又获得了约15%的涨幅。）1919年，为了缓解欧洲的粮食短缺，香港曾向欧洲运送大米，导致当地粮食严重短缺，价格飞涨，政府不得不实施价格限制。为了支持他们的诉求，中国技工学会聘请了著名的欧亚混血律师罗文锦。在雇主——主要是船坞、电力公司以及政府本身——四次拒绝了他们的要求后，工人们于3月31日开始罢工。短短一周内，近万名工人加入罢工，香港经济陷入瘫痪。许多罢工者前往广州，在那里他们得到了孙中山政府和当地工会的支持。尽管包括许多欧洲人在内的大多数香港人都认为工人的要求是合理的，但雇主拒绝让步。罢工持续了三个多星期，最终在国务卿贺力法施压下，雇主才同意给工人加薪32.5%。

The 1920 strike was mainly economic, but it had important ramifications（众多复杂而又难以预料的）结果，后果 beyond the economic realm 领域；范围.

Example 2. 案例
ramification

→ 来自拉丁语 ramus,树枝，小枝，词源同 root.-fy,使。

英 / ˌræmɪfɪˈkeɪʃn /　美 / ˌræmɪfɪˈkeɪʃn /　全球发音

简明　牛津　新牛津　韦氏　柯林斯　例句　百科

ram·ifi·ca·tion *n.* / ˌræmɪfɪˈkeɪʃn /

[usually pl.]one of the large number of complicated and unexpected results that follow an action or a decision（众多复杂而又难以预料的）结果，后果

SYN complication

• These changes are bound to have widespread social ramifications.这些变化注定会造成许多难以预料的社会后果。

A victory for *organized (a.) labor* 工会劳工；有组织的劳工, the strike showed (v.) how workers had learned (v.) the importance of organizing — 主 more than one hundred unions 谓 were formed in 1920 alone — and how to use (v.) strikes for *collective bargaining* 集体谈判；劳资谈判.

这次罢工是有组织的劳工取得的一次胜利，它表明工人们已经认识到 组织起来的重要性——仅在1920年就成立了一百多个工会——以及如何利用罢工进行集体谈判。

The strike also revealed 主 how organizations such as *the Tung Wah Hospital* 东华医院 系 were no longer able to mediate (v.)调停；调解；斡旋 **between** the Chinese working classes **and** the colonial government.

By this time, organized workers had the power **to deal directly with** their employers.

主 The government, which had been (先发生) completely **unprepared (a.)无准备的；即席的；尚未准备好的 for** a *labor union* to gain so much power, 谓 subsequently **took (后发生) a more proactive (a.)积极主动的 role** in managing (v.) Chinese guilds 行会；同业公会, unions, and other associations 协会；社团；联盟.

主 The Societies Ordinance 条例；法令 of 1920 谓 prohibited 禁止；阻止 any society 后定说明 having ① "*unlawful 非法的；违法的 purposes* ② or *purposes* 后定说明 incompatible (a.) 不相容的；不一致的 with *the peace and good order* 和平与良好秩序 of the Colony."

《1920年社团条例》禁止任何社团 (这个社团是具有"非法目的, 或目的与'殖民地之和平及良好秩序'不相容的")。

Example 3. 案例

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【主句】 The Societies Ordinance of 1920 prohibited any society...
│
├─ 主语：The Societies Ordinance
│        └─ 【后置定语】 of 1920
│
├─ 谓语：prohibited
└─ 宾语：any society
         │
         └─ 【后置定语】 having "unlawful purposes or purposes incompatible with
            (现在分词短语，修饰 society)
            │
            ├─ 核心动词：having
            └─ 宾语："unlawful purposes or purposes
                 │
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├─ 【并列定语1】 unlawful
├─ 并列连词：or
├─ 【并列定语2】 incompatible with the peace and good order
│      （形容词短语，作后置定语修饰第二个 purposes）
│      └─ 【后置定语】 of the Colony
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While the ordinance banned (v.) triad 三合会；黑社会 groups, it also banned a dozen *considerably 相当地；非常地 less controversial 有争议的 groups* —including the Hotel Boys and Cook Guild（由工作、目标或兴趣相同的人组成的）协会, the Knitters’ (编织工) Union, the Christian Youth Groups, and the Barbers’ (理发店) Union.

这项法令在禁止三合会组织的同时，还取缔了十几个争议性小得多的团体，其中包括酒店员工与厨师行会、编织工联盟、基督教青年团体, 以及理发师联盟。

Example 4. 案例

英文原名	中文参考译名	组织性质
Hotel Boys and Cook Guild	旅馆侍应与厨师公会	餐饮旅馆业的基层员工组织。**当时“Guild”常译为“行会”或“公所”。**
Knitters’ Union	织造工会	纺织业工人的联合组织。当时香港的家庭式织造工场和小型工厂非常多。
Christian Youth Groups	基督教青年团体	如 YMCA 等性质的宗教背景社团，致力于青年活动与社会服务。
Barbers’ Union	理发业工会	剃头、理发从业者的职业团体，通常也具有同乡会或互助会的性质。

Finally, the strike 谓 affected (v.) workers in neighboring 邻近的；附近的 Canton, who subsequently **went on their own strike** and **obtained 获得；得到 better wages**.

In 1921 alone, workers there 谓 organized *successful strikes* in every major industry.

Example 5. 案例

The 1920 strike was mainly economic, but it had important ramifications beyond the economic realm.
A victory for organized labor, the strike showed how workers had learned the importance of organizing—more than one hundred unions were formed in 1920 alone—and how to use strikes for collective bargaining.
The strike also revealed how organizations such as the Tung Wah Hospital were no longer able to mediate between the Chinese working classes and the colonial government.
By this time, organized workers had the power to deal directly with their employers.
The government, which had been completely unprepared for a labor union to gain so much power, subsequently took a more proactive role in managing Chinese guilds, unions, and other associations.
The Societies Ordinance of 1920 prohibited any society having “unlawful purposes or purposes incompatible with the peace and good order of the Colony.” While the ordinance banned triad groups, it also banned a dozen considerably less controversial groups—including the Hotel Boys and Cook Guild, the Knitters’ Union, the Christian Youth Groups, and the Barbers’ Union.
Finally, the strike affected workers in neighboring Canton, who subsequently went on their own strike and obtained better wages.
In 1921 alone, workers there organized successful strikes in every major industry.

1920年的罢工主要是一场经济运动，但其影响远不止于经济领域。这场罢工是劳工组织的胜利，它表明工人们已经认识到组织起来的重要性——仅1920年一年就成立了一百多个工会——以及如何利用罢工进行集体谈判。罢工也揭示了像东华医院这样的组织已无法再在华工阶级和殖民政府之间进行调解。此时，有组织的工人已经拥有了直接与雇主谈判的权力。政府对工会获得如此大的权力毫无准备，随后开始更加积极地管理华人行会、工会和其他社团。1920年的《社团条例》禁止任何“目的非法或与殖民地和平与良好秩序不符”的社团成立。虽然该法令取缔了三合会组织，但也取缔了十几个争议较小的团体，包括酒店男工和厨师协会、针织工会、基督教青年团体以及理发师工会。最终，罢工波及到邻近的坎顿市，当地工人随后也举行了罢工，并争取到了更高的工资。仅在1921年，坎顿市的工人就在各大行业组织了多次成功的罢工。